

AUTOBOTS

Yes, we're aware that we sound like Optimus Prime calling his Transformers to attention, but we're not predicting any Transformers (though that would be seriously cool). We mean self-driving cars, self-maneuvering farm equipment, autonomous quadcopters, ships and submarines

Obviously the most visible of these will be the self-driving cars. Then there are companies like Starship Technologies (starship.xyz), a company started who are using little autonomous robots that look like little boxes on wheels, to deliver food to people. It's being trialed at software company Intuit's 4.3 acre California headquarters. You pop open an app, order what you want, and then select a pin on a map (outdoors) and then wait for your food to arrive. When the little bot gets there, an average of 17 minutes later, you press a button on your app to open it and take out your food.

Then of course there is always some company or the other using drones to deliver packages, and we're working our way towards driverless taxis... eventually we're going to be surrounded by machines that just go about doing things on their own, and more importantly, we won't bat an eyelid and be as mistrusting as we are now.

MEDICINE

When it comes to medicine, the priority has always been to ease suffering and cure diseases. But the more we know about diseases, the more we find the need to get the diagnostics correct, and start treatment as early as possible. This isn't just for medical illnesses, but also for things such as autism, mental health problems, Alzheimer's and various other ageing problems.

MH370 Found

Almost a year to the date after Elon Musk launched his Tesla Model U autonomous submarine line in June 2027, and vowed to finally find the missing Malaysian Airline flight MH370, his fleet of 25 Model U (named after the German U-boats of WWII) submarines have returned the first images of the surprisingly intact Boeing 777-R on the bottom of the Indian ocean, about 200 KM south of where the search was conducted over a decade ago. The internet is already blowing up with speculation about what happened, based on the two grainy photographs that Musk tweeted earlier today.

Though we can hope for cures for some things, some others like the ones we just mentioned are more about palliative care than cures.

But it's not all good news, however, as many, including Bill Gates, have sent out dire warnings about our general unpreparedness for the next big epidemic. If a superbug were to mutate, or worse still be genetically engineered by a bio-terrorist organisation, we stand to lose millions of lives, especially across the developing world. We can never forget that we're merely a life form, and we exist along with a trillion other life forms that are all struggling to attain dominance. We're literally at war with other life, and in every war there are events that cause mass casualties.

LIFE IN 2028

Life in 2028 is basically our vision of what the next decade has in store for us as individuals.

We expect a new interface to arise and replace the old touch interface. Perhaps a sophisticated amalgam of eye-tracking and silent speech recognition will drive the next interfaces. While inside our homes and our phones, smart assistants will steal the show, but on the go and in public, more silent methods will be required in order to interface with our devices.

We also expect the bordering on paranoid privacy concerns of just now to be forgotten and buried in the future, as people stop caring about privacy. In fact we have no doubt that personal privacy will stop mattering in as little as 7 to 8 years, because online socialising requires that we open up, and not shut down ourselves.

More and more people will find their way out of poverty and get an education. Access to the internet will raise literacy to unheard of levels and we're pretty sure all of us writers will have our days numbered the instant a machine learns to do some creative writing.

As more jobs are relegated to robots, newer jobs will form where the human mind is a little more unique. We will have better healthcare, longer and happier lives and of course, more food on the table per person.

So what do you think the future holds for us? Agree or disagree with anything we've said, or want to make predictions of your own? Write in to us at editor@digit.com and not only will we publish the best suggestions, we will also give away some exciting goodies, in a lucky draw. Quick, get cracking on that email! 

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Sales enquiries: rohit_kamboj@asus.com
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